PEOPLE & CULTURE · TALEEMABAD

We Used to Stay *Silent.*

A story about two values — and what happened when we lived them.

COURAGEOUS CONVERSATIONS | CONTINUOUSLY IMPROVE

THE BEFORE

Like most companies, we didn't *respond.*

When a candidate's profile wasn't the right fit, we moved on quietly. No feedback. No closure. Just silence.

It felt like the safe choice. Saying nothing meant no risk of an awkward conversation, no chance of someone pushing back, no uncomfortable territory.

> ***But at some point, we asked ourselves a harder question: is silence actually kind — or is it just comfortable for us?***

The answer was uncomfortable. **Candidates put real effort into applying.** They wrote cover letters. They tailored their CVs. They waited. And we were giving them nothing in return.

VALUE 01 · COURAGEOUS CONVERSATIONS

We decided to say the *hard thing.*

Telling someone their CV has gaps is not a comfortable thing to do. A candidate could feel judged. They could push back. They could leave with a worse impression of Taleemabad than if we had said nothing at all.

That risk was real. We chose to take it anyway.

We wrote honest, specific emails. We named the gap — directly, without softening it into meaninglessness. We acknowledged what was genuinely strong in each profile. We gave real, actionable direction.

> ***A courageous conversation isn't just saying the hard thing. It's saying it in a way the other person can actually receive.***

VALUE 02 · CONTINUOUSLY IMPROVE

We treated it as *a craft.*

This wasn't just about being kind to candidates. It was about raising our own standard — improving how we communicate, even in moments that are easy to rush through or automate.

We read every CV before writing. We found something worth acknowledging in each one. We named the gap specifically, not vaguely. We gave direction that was actually useful — not just a consolation.

It took more time. It was worth it.

> ***Continuously Improving Our Craft means getting better at the things that are easy to do badly — and deciding not to.***

IT COULD HAVE GONE BADLY. IT DIDN'T.

What candidates *wrote back.*

We were prepared for pushback. Rejection emails with real feedback are uncommon for a reason — people assume candidates won't receive them well. Dozens of candidates wrote back. Not to negotiate. Not to ask for another chance.

Just to say thank you.

> *I'll be honest, receiving a rejection is never easy, but the way you delivered this one made all the difference. Thank you for seeing me as more than just an application.*
>
> CANDIDATE · FIELD COORDINATOR ROLE

> *This is one of the best rejections I have ever received. This is one of the reasons which always encourages me to be part of Taleemabad.*
>
> CANDIDATE · FIELD COORDINATOR ROLE

> *It is genuinely rare to receive a response this considered. It speaks well of Taleemabad's culture that you give applicants honest, constructive guidance rather than a standard reply.*
>
> CANDIDATE · FIELD COORDINATOR ROLE

WHAT THIS MEANS

Values aren't on a wall. They're in the *small decisions.*

Courageous Conversations and Continuously Improving Our Craft are not abstract ideas we discuss in team meetings. They are decisions made in ordinary moments — like how you tell someone no.

We started telling people no with honesty, care, and craft. That changed how candidates experience Taleemabad — even the ones who don't join us.

> ***How we say no defines who we are.***

People & Culture Team
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